

Launchpad Enterprise Roadmap

Strategic features and changes to drive company adoption — July 30, 2026

Executive summary

Launchpad already unifies ephemeral previews, multi-cloud IaC workspaces, manifest deploy, GitHub App integration, org RBAC, OIDC SSO, audit logs, cost caps, drift scanning, and Dockerfile/CI scaffolding. The gap for company adoption is enterprise trust, golden paths, and workflow depth—not more isolated features.

Current strengths

- Unified preview + IaC provision + manifest deploy in one portal
- Local kind → cloud promotion path for incremental adoption
- Governance: namespace quotas, network policies, TTL, soft cost caps
- GitHub App: PR comments, commit status, webhook rebuilds
- OIDC SSO with group→role mapping and org invites
- Audit logs, drift scanning, Dockerfile tooling, workspace IDE + terminal
- Multi-cloud: GCP, AWS, Azure, Cloudflare, and local kind

Enterprise adoption blockers

Area	You have	Companies expect
Identity	OIDC + group→role	SAML + SCIM, enforced MFA via IdP
Governance	Quotas, TTL, cost caps	Kyverno/OPA policy packs, prod approval gates
Secrets	Session-injected creds	Vault / cloud SM + External Secrets
Audit	Per-environment audit API	Org-wide export, retention, SIEM integration
Isolation	Namespace governance	Dedicated clusters/cells per team or env class
Reliability	OCI deploy pack	HA reference arch, backup/restore, SLO monitoring

Without these, platform teams treat Launchpad as a dev toy—not something for 200+ engineers.

High-impact differentiators

1. PR-native preview environments

Your killer wedge. Extend GitHub integration beyond comments and commit status:

- Stable preview URL per PR (e.g. pr-42.preview.company.com)
- Auto smoke test against preview URL before marking status green
- “Open in Launchpad” deep link from GitHub Checks
- Auto-destroy on PR merge/close
- Optional: post screenshot or Lighthouse score to the PR

Developers feel this daily. Backstage catalogs don't do previews; many preview tools don't do IaC.

2. Golden path service catalog

Evolve catalog templates into org-approved service definitions:

- Service definitions with owner, tier, SLO, runbook, on-call
- Scorecards: Dockerfile, CI, monitoring, drift-free
- One-click Create service → repo + Dockerfile + CI + K8s + workspace
- Template versioning; org-approved stacks only

Position as: Backstage catalog + preview environments + Terraform generation in one product.

3. Dependency-aware previews

Preview envs that only deploy the app feel hollow:

- Ephemeral Postgres/Redis (operator or Helm subchart)
- DB seed from fixture or snapshot
- Internal DNS so api and web preview together
- Preview stack from monorepo path filters

Major gap vs Okteto/Humanitec—compelling for real production-like apps.

4. Promotion pipeline with approvals

Extend promote_environment_to_cloud into a governed path:

- preview (PR) → staging (auto on merge) → production (manual approval)
- GitHub Environment protection rules generated by Launchpad
- Approval UI + audit who approved
- Diff of manifest/IaC between stages; rollback to known-good revision

Companies buy controlled change—not just fast deploys.

5. FinOps that finance understands

Extend hourly/accrued cost and soft caps:

- Cost per team/project/service
- Budget alerts in Slack
- Estimated cost before launch on the Launch page
- Idle detection: pause envs with no traffic for 24h
- Monthly export for cloud billing reconciliation

Platform teams must justify the tool to finance.

6. Policy-as-code center

Turn governance into an org admin UI:

- No hostPath, no privileged, require runAsNonRoot
- Block deploy if Trivy/SAST exceeds org threshold
- Required labels/annotations on all workloads
- Exceptions with expiry and approver

Sell governed self-service—the phrase enterprise buyers use.

7. Platform engineering dashboard

Control tower for the internal platform team:

- Active previews, median time-to-ready, failure rate
- Top failing repos / templates
- Drift count by workspace
- DORA-style metrics and budget leaderboard

Makes Launchpad the operational hub—not just a launch button.

Workflow integrations

- Slack/Teams: env ready, failed, TTL expiring, budget exceeded
- Jira/Linear: link preview URL to ticket; auto-comment on issue
- PagerDuty/Opsgenie: service catalog ties to on-call
- Datadog/New Relic: auto-inject tracing env vars in preview manifests

Each integration is a checkbox on an enterprise RFP.

Production-ready polish

- Custom domains + TLS for previews
- Environment sharing with scoped reviewer access
- Read-only mode for auditors
- Public API + Terraform provider for launchpad_environment resources
- White-label: org logo, custom docs, branded status pages
- Multi-region: launch preview closest to reviewer

Suggested roadmap

Phase	Timeline	Deliverables
Phase 1	3–6 weeks	PR preview URLs, auto-destroy on PR close, smoke-test gate, Slack notifications
Phase 2	6–10 weeks	Service catalog + software templates, ephemeral DB/redis, cost-before-launch
Phase 3	10–16 weeks	Staging/prod promotion with approvals, policy UI, org audit export
Phase 4	Ongoing	SCIM, Vault integration, HA multi-tenant deployment, Terraform provider

Competitive positioning

Competitor	Their strength	Your angle
Backstage	Catalog, plugins	Ship previews and infra—not just docs
Humanitec / Qovery	Orchestration, dependencies	Multi-cloud IaC + previews without vendor lock-in
Okteto / DevPod	Dev environments	Governed previews + prod promotion path
Porter / Coherence	PaaS simplicity	Bring your cloud; we generate Terraform/Pulumi

Strategic choice

Pick your primary buyer: (1) Platform engineering → catalog, policy, FinOps, SIEM, promotion pipelines. (2) Product engineering → PR previews, dependencies, GitHub UX. Lead with PR previews + golden paths for adoption; add policy + FinOps + identity for enterprise contracts.

Unique combo: local kind → cloud workspace → manifest deploy → ephemeral preview → promote, all governed. Almost no competitor does this end-to-end in one portal.